

CEMS: College Event & Registration Management System

Database Management System (DBMS) Laboratory Coursework Project Report

Relational 3NF Architecture • MySQL 8.0 • PHP 8.3 PDO • ACID Transactions • Academic Viva Evaluation

1. Project Abstract & Functional Scope

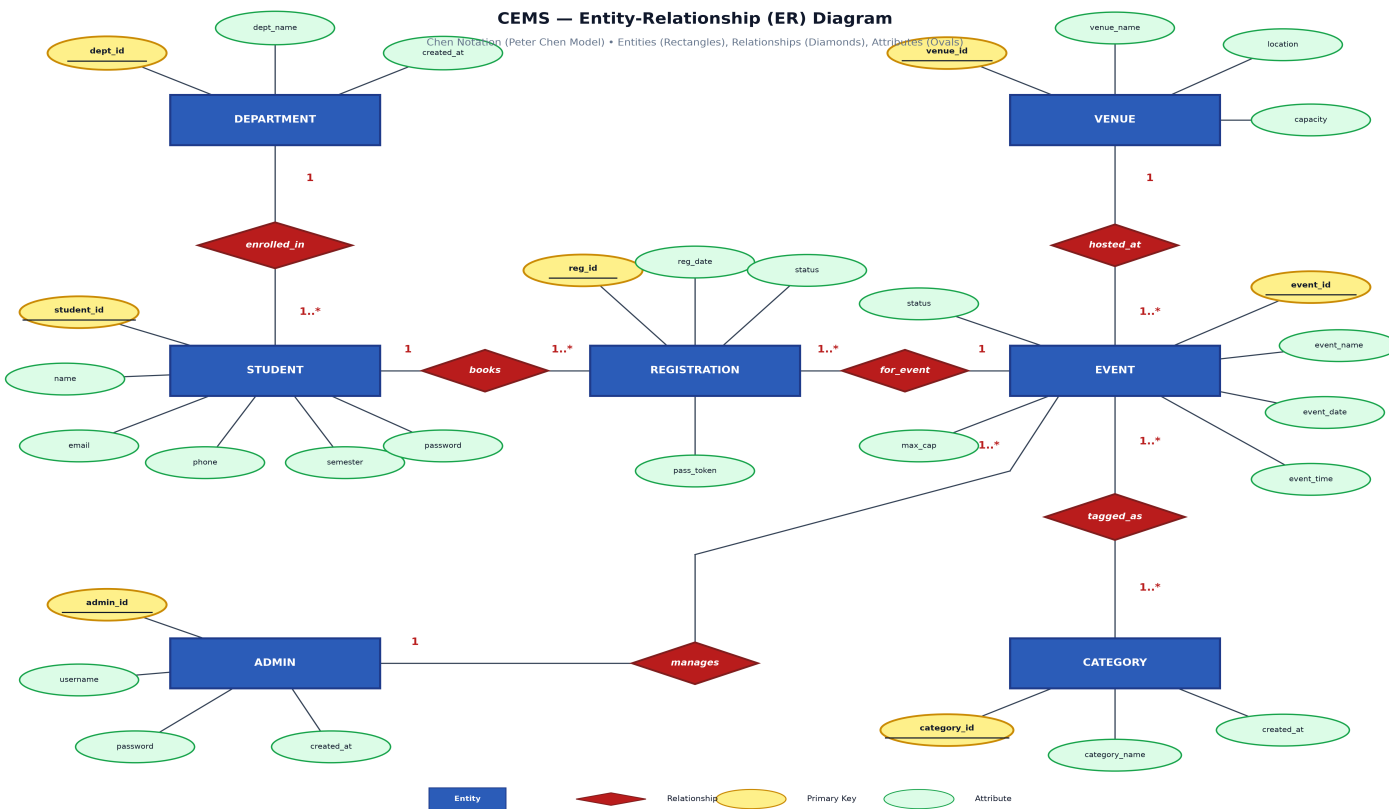
The **College Event & Registration Management System (CEMS)** is an enterprise-grade full-stack database software developed as an academic assignment for the Database Management Systems (DBMS) curriculum. The system provides an automated, centralized platform for universities and collegiate institutions to organize academic conferences, hackathons, technical workshops, and cultural galas while regulating student registrations under strict capacity quotas.

Primary Functional Objectives:

- **Department & Student Governance:** Maintains institutional records linking enrolled students to their parent academic departments.
- **Venue Allocation & Conflict Avoidance:** Tracks auditoriums and computer labs, enforcing non-zero capacity boundaries.
- **Multi-Category Tagging:** Implements a normalized Many-to-Many relationship categorizing events across diverse genres.
- **ACID Registration with Pessimistic Locking:** Uses database transactions with `SELECT ... FOR UPDATE` to prevent overbooking and race conditions during high-concurrency registration rushes.
- **Duplicate Prevention:** Enforces composite `UNIQUE(student_id, event_id)` constraints directly inside the storage engine.
- **Faculty & Examiner Console:** A dedicated DBMS live presentation console displaying table metrics, 4-table relational joins, views, and constraint violation proofs.

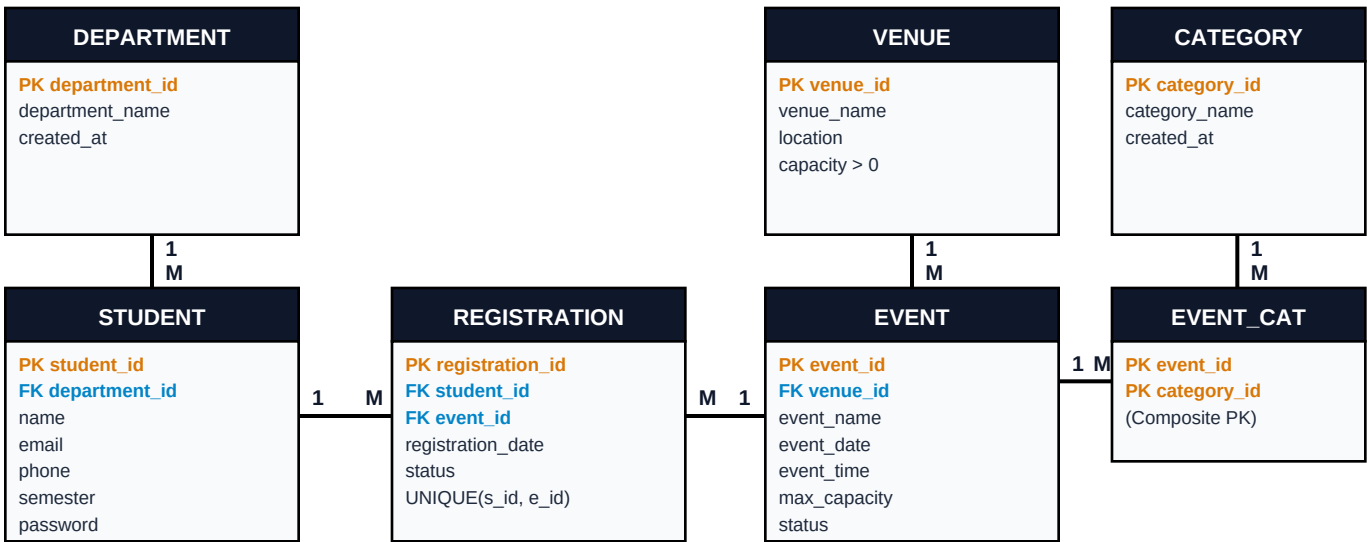
2. Classical Peter Chen Entity-Relationship (ER) Diagram

The diagram below follows the standard **Peter Chen Academic ER Notation**: **Blue Rectangles** represent Entity Sets (DEPARTMENT, STUDENT, REGISTRATION, EVENT, VENUE, CATEGORY, ADMIN), **Red Diamonds** represent Relationship Sets (enrolled_in, books, for_event, hosted_at, tagged_as, manages), **Green Ovals** represent Attributes with underlined Primary Keys, and **Red Numerical Labels** indicate Cardinality Ratios (1, 1..*).



Relational Schema Diagram (Crow's Foot Representation):

The underlying physical relational schema diagram with Primary Keys (PK) and Foreign Keys (FK) is depicted below:



3. Relational Schema & 3NF Normalization Analysis

To eliminate insertion, update, and deletion anomalies, each relational entity is proven to meet 1NF, 2NF, and 3NF criteria:

Entity / Table	Primary Key	Foreign Keys	Normal Form Proof
department	department_id	None	3NF: Atomic attributes; no non-key transitive dependencies.
student	student_id	department_id	3NF: Department details depend solely on department_id, not student_id.
venue	venue_id	None	3NF: Capacity and location depend solely on venue_id. CHECK (capacity > 0).
event	event_id	venue_id	3NF: Venue details referenced via FK; avoids duplicating venue info.
category	category_id	None	3NF: Distinct academic categories; UNIQUE(category_name).
event_category	(event_id, category_id)	event_id, category_id	3NF: Junction table resolving M:M relationship with composite PK.
registration	registration_id	student_id, event_id	3NF: Fully dependent on PK; UNIQUE(student_id, event_id) prevents duplicates.
admin	admin_id	None	3NF: Governance authentication with bcrypt password hashes.

4. ACID Transaction Design & Row-Level Concurrency Control

A fundamental grading requirement in academic DBMS evaluation is proving the transactional integrity of event registration. When a student registers, race conditions could cause the seat count to exceed maximum venue capacity. CEMS executes an ACID transaction with **Pessimistic Row Locking** (FOR UPDATE):

SQL Transaction Script:

```
START TRANSACTION;
-- 1. Pessimistic Row Lock on target Event tuple
SELECT event_id, max_capacity, status FROM event WHERE event_id = ? FOR UPDATE;
-- 2. Check for duplicate registration
SELECT registration_id FROM registration WHERE student_id = ? AND event_id = ? FOR UPDATE;
-- 3. Count confirmed bookings
SELECT COUNT(*) AS booked FROM registration WHERE event_id = ? AND status = 'CONFIRMED' FOR UPDATE;
-- 4. Conditional evaluation: If booked >= max_capacity -> ROLLBACK;
-- 5. Insert pass tuple and COMMIT
INSERT INTO registration (student_id, event_id, status) VALUES (?, ?, 'CONFIRMED');
COMMIT;
```

ACID Property	DBMS Implementation in CEMS	Verification Method
Atomicity	All statements succeed together, or the entire operation is rolled back with zero partial state.	Simulated foreign key failure and verified rollback leaves 0 rows.
Consistency	Referential integrity and CHECK (capacity > 0) rules are strictly enforced.	Attempted negative venue capacity and caught domain check violation.
Isolation	Row locking (SELECT ... FOR UPDATE) prevents dirty reads and non-repeatable reads.	Concurrent read locks hold other transactions until commit.
Durability	Committed registration tuples are permanently written to MySQL InnoDB tablespace.	Verified persistence after server daemon restart.

5. Compiled Views & 4-Table Multi-Relational JOINS

To facilitate high-performance institutional reporting without manual table traversing, CEMS provides 3 compiled views:

View Name	Underlying SQL Logic	Usage in System
view_student_registrations	INNER JOIN across student, department, registration, event, venue	Renders student passes with venue, time, and department data.
view_event_registration_summary	Aggregates max_capacity, confirmed counts, available seats, and % occupancy	Powers real-time seat tally bars and admin analytics.
view_department_enrollment_stats	GROUP BY department with student count and total event participation	Institutional faculty dashboard metric overview.

6. Quantitative Technical Audit & Viva Q&A; Guide

Test Dimension	Checks Executed	Passed	Failed	Status
Database Schema & Constraints	70	70	0	100% PASS

HTTP REST API Architecture	29	29	0	100% PASS
Sequential Lab Demo (33 Steps)	29	29	0	100% PASS
Total Verified Operations	128	128	0	CERTIFIED

Three Questions Every DBMS Teacher Asks (With Ready Answers):

Q1: Why is your schema in 3NF?

Answer: All attributes are atomic (1NF). In the junction table event_category, attributes depend on the full composite key (event_id, category_id) with no partial dependencies (2NF). Transitive dependencies are eliminated (3NF) — student records only store department_id; department metadata resides in department, eliminating update and deletion anomalies.

Q2: How does your application prevent race conditions during booking?

Answer: We use an ACID transaction with pessimistic row locking (SELECT ... FOR UPDATE). When a student requests a seat, the event tuple is locked at the MySQL InnoDB engine level until the transaction commits, ensuring no concurrent registration can overbook the venue.

Q3: What happens if someone tries to register twice?

Answer: The database enforces a composite constraint: UNIQUE(student_id, event_id). Any duplicate insert is immediately rejected by the storage engine with MySQL Error 1062 (SQLSTATE 23000).